Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠3

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥3

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦J

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥5

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K J 4 ♥ Q 10 ♦ K Q J 6 ♣ A 9 7 3	
♠ 10 8 7 ♥ K 5 4 ♦ A 10 8 4 ♣ K 10 5		♠ Q 6 5 3 2 ♥ 7 6 2 ♦ 9 3 ♣ Q 4 2
	♠ A 9 ♥ A J 9 8 3 ♦ 7 5 2 ♣ J 8 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♠3

SOUTH has 11 points and five ♥s, so she responds 2♦ as a Jacoby Transfer.

When NORTH bids the required 2♥, SOUTH jumps to 3NT to show at least 11 points, but only a 5-card ♥ suit.

Since NORTH has only a doubleton ♥ she passes 3NT.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A 10 ♥ K Q 10 9 ♦ J 10 6 2 ♣ 10 6 2	
♠ Q 8 7 6 3 2 ♥ 8 5 ♦ 9 5 4 ♣ 5 3		♠ K J 5 ♥ A 7 6 ♦ A 8 3 ♣ K Q 9 4
	♠ 9 4 ♥ J 4 3 2 ♦ K Q 7 ♣ A J 8 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♥	Pass	2♠	
All Pass			

2♠ by East
Lead: ♥3

EAST, with a balanced 17 point hand naturally opens 1NT.

WEST has a really awful hand, but she does hold six ♠s. So she uses Jacoby Transfer, and when EAST bids 2♠ she passes!

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A K 7 2 ♥ A J 8 6 ♦ 5 3 ♣ 10 8 4	
♠ 5 4 ♥ K 7 4 ♦ J 10 9 8 ♣ Q J 9 7	N W E S	♠ J 10 9 8 ♥ 5 3 ♦ K Q 4 2 ♣ 6 5 2
	♠ Q 6 3 ♥ Q 10 9 2 ♦ A 7 6 ♣ A K 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♦J

NORTH has four cards in each Major suit - this is an ideal situation for Stayman.

SOUTH shows a ♥ suit and NORTH immediately bids game in that suit.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

♠ J 6
♥ 10 7 5
♦ A 8 5
♣ K 10 7 4 2

♠ A Q 8 2
♥ A Q 3
♦ K 10 6 2
♣ A Q

♠ K 9 7 4
♥ K 8 6 2
♦ 7 3
♣ 8 6 5

♠ 10 5 3
♥ J 9 4
♦ Q J 9 4
♣ J 9 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2NT	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♥5

Stayman convention works just fine after a 2NT opening, just at a higher level.

EAST knows that 6 points will be enough for game opposite WEST's 20-21, she just needs to find out if there is a 4-4 Major suit fit. There is, in ♠s.